In the next chapter, you learn how to distribute actors evenly in the cluster to avoid having too many actors in one node and too few in another. You also see how to persist the state of an actor in a durable store.

Summary

- Creating a cluster is as simple as setting the actor provider, remote, and seed nodes in the configuration and creating an `ActorSystem` at the command line.
- The node's lifecycle is a state machine, from `Joining` the cluster to being `Removed`, with all the intermediate states: `WeaklyUp`, `Up`, `Leaving`, `Down`, and `Exiting`.
- With the cluster configuration, you can use the word-counting application and run actors on different nodes. When you shut down some nodes and create new ones, the application reaches a new level of resilience and scalability. No work is lost, and counting can continue when new nodes are added to the cluster.
- When you test the application logic, you don't have to worry about the cluster. These areas are separated, and you can focus on the business logic without thinking about clustering. Akka takes care of that for you.